

FREE GUIDE • THE OP TEAM

# BUYING A HOME IN VAUGHAN

The 15 steps from deciding to buy to getting your keys, with a checklist for each one.

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**STEP 1 OF 15**

# KNOW YOUR WHY

**Your reason decides what to look for.**

More space, a better school, a shorter commute, a first home: your reason tells us what to look for and what to skip.

Write down your must-haves and your nice-to-haves before you start.

- |                                                                            |                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Why are you moving?                               | <input type="checkbox"/> When do you need to be in? |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Your must-haves: bedrooms, area, schools, parking | <input type="checkbox"/> Your nice-to-haves         |

**STEP 2 OF 15**

# INTERVIEW REALTORS

**Find someone who works for you.**

Meet two or three agents. Ask how they help buyers win in multiple offers and how they will keep you updated.

In Ontario you sign a written buyer representation agreement with your agent, so understand it before you sign.

- |                                                                              |                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> How many buyers have you helped in this area?       | <input type="checkbox"/> How do you win in a bidding war? |
| <input type="checkbox"/> How will you find homes before they hit the market? | <input type="checkbox"/> How does your fee work?          |

**MICHAEL'S TIP:** Michael holds the ABR® designation, Accredited Buyer Representative, with training focused on buyers.

## STEP 3 OF 15

## GET PRE-APPROVED

**Know your budget before you fall in love.**

A lender checks your income, debts and credit and confirms how much you can borrow. Many will hold a rate for up to 120 days.

Lenders also test whether you could afford payments at a higher rate (the stress test), so your budget may be lower than you expect.

- |                                                                            |                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Gather pay stubs, tax returns and bank statements | <input type="checkbox"/> Talk to a bank and a mortgage broker                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Get your pre-approval in writing                  | <input type="checkbox"/> Know your monthly comfort zone, not just the maximum |

## STEP 4 OF 15

## KNOW YOUR CLOSING COSTS

**Budget for more than the down payment.**

Plan for about 2% of the price on top of your down payment. Most of it is Ontario land transfer tax: about \$22,500 on a \$1.3 million home in Vaughan.

In Toronto you also pay a municipal land transfer tax. First-time buyers can get up to \$4,000 back from Ontario, plus up to \$4,475 from Toronto.

- |                                            |                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Land transfer tax | <input type="checkbox"/> Legal fees and title insurance       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Home inspection   | <input type="checkbox"/> Adjustments for prepaid property tax |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Moving costs      |                                                               |

## STEP 5 OF 15

## CHOOSE YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD

**Compare before you fall for a house.**

Prices, schools, commute and resale value can change street by street.

Our neighbourhood guides at soldmike.com cover Woodbridge, Vellore, Kleinburg, Maple, King, Caledon, East Gwillimbury and Toronto.

- ☐ Drive the area at rush hour
- ☐ Check school boundaries with the school board
- ☐ Walk the street on a weekend
- ☐ Ask what is planned nearby

## STEP 6 OF 15

## TOUR HOMES

**Look past the staging.**

See homes in person. Staging and photos are designed to impress, so look at the bones.

Check the layout, light, roof, windows, furnace and air conditioner age, and any signs of water.

- ☐ Take photos and notes at every showing
- ☐ Open closets and look under sinks
- ☐ Ask the age of the roof, furnace and windows
- ☐ Picture your furniture in each room

## STEP 7 OF 15

# CHECK THE VALUE

**Know what it is really worth.**

Before you write an offer, we pull recent sales nearby so you know what the home is really worth.

That number guides your offer, especially in a bidding war.

- ☐ Compare sales from the last 3 to 6 months
- ☐ Adjust for size, lot, condition and parking
- ☐ Decide your top price before offer night

## STEP 8 OF 15

# WRITE THE OFFER

**Every term is a lever.**

Your offer sets the price, deposit, conditions, closing date and what is included.

In a competitive market, a clean offer with a strong deposit can beat a higher price with conditions.

- ☐ Price
- ☐ Deposit: about 5% is common in the GTA
- ☐ Conditions: financing, inspection, status certificate
- ☐ Closing date
- ☐ Inclusions

## STEP 9 OF 15

# NEGOTIATE

**Win it at the right price.**

One-on-one, we negotiate price and terms with the listing agent. In multiple offers, everyone sends their best offer and the seller chooses.

As a Real Estate Negotiation Expert (RENE), Michael builds offers that stand out without overpaying.

☐ Know your walk-away price

☐ Have your deposit ready

☐ Be reachable on offer night

## STEP 10 OF 15

# SUBMIT YOUR DEPOSIT

**Usually within 24 hours.**

Once your offer is accepted, your deposit goes to the listing brokerage, held in trust, usually within 24 hours.

It counts toward your down payment on closing day.

☐ Have the funds ready before offer night

☐ Use a bank draft or wire as instructed

☐ Keep your receipt

## STEP 11 OF 15

# CLEAR YOUR CONDITIONS

**Each condition has a deadline.**

Common conditions are financing, a home inspection and, for condos, a review of the status certificate by your lawyer. Each has a deadline, often about five business days.

If a condition is not met, you can walk away and get your deposit back.

- |                                                                                |                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Send the deal to your lender right away               | <input type="checkbox"/> Book your home inspection                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Get the status certificate to your lawyer for a condo | <input type="checkbox"/> Waive conditions only when you are satisfied |

## STEP 12 OF 15

# GO FIRM

**The home is yours, pending closing.**

Once every condition is waived, the deal is firm. Resale homes in Ontario have no cooling-off period, so this is the point of no return.

Now it is about getting to closing.

- |                                                            |                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Send the firm deal to your lawyer | <input type="checkbox"/> Lock in your mortgage |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Plan your move                    |                                                |

**STEP 13 OF 15**

# LAWYER AND INSURANCE

## Paperwork before the keys.

Your lawyer searches the title, arranges title insurance and prepares the closing documents.

Your lender needs proof of home insurance before closing day.

- |                                                                                 |                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Hire a real estate lawyer                              | <input type="checkbox"/> Get home insurance in place      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Send the down payment and closing costs to your lawyer | <input type="checkbox"/> Set up utilities for closing day |

**STEP 14 OF 15**

# FINAL WALKTHROUGH

## See it again before closing.

Most offers include visits before closing. Use the last one to check everything is as agreed.

Make sure included items are there and nothing is damaged.

- |                                                                     |                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check appliances and included items        | <input type="checkbox"/> Run taps, test lights and the furnace |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Note anything wrong and tell us right away |                                                                |

## CLOSING DAY

On closing day your lawyer sends the funds, the deed registers in your name and you pick up the keys.

- ☐ Pick up keys as arranged with your lawyer
- ☐ Change the locks and garage codes
- ☐ Keep your closing documents somewhere safe

## YOUR NOTES

# LET'S FIND YOUR HOME

Michael helps buyers across Vaughan, Woodbridge, Kleinburg, King, Caledon and Toronto, in English and Italian.

## MICHAEL BARILLARI

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